

Gaming Gear**73**

We take a look at some of the hottest gaming accessories such as gaming mice, gaming wheels and keyboards and so on

Ultrabooks Test**80**

14 competitors face-off against each other in this battle for the best Ultrabook in town



Big things in Mini packages

Want to turn your flat-screen TV into a second PC? We give you the lowdown on the Mini ITX boards to make your next HTPC

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Mini ITX form factor boards are dime-a-dozen in the market. Some of them come with on-board processors, whereas others are like any normal motherboard – just having the chipset and you will have to add in all the other components. We decided to concentrate on the former for the purpose of this test, and will cover the latter in the coming months. We are all familiar with power-hungry rigs which are meant for resource-intensive tasks. But there are some users who want a very basic low-power setup, needed to handle the most

basic tasks. There are a range of boards out there in the market for this set of discerning users, who have a mainstream PC for all their work and who are looking to get one for casual use which has a compact footprint – perfect for a Home theatre PC.

The most common processor sported amongst all the participants was the AMD E 350 with the Hudson M1 and Hudson D1 chipset. On the other hand we had the Intel Cedar Trail processors with the Intel NM10 chipset. There was a lone board with the VIA chipset.

The Contenders

AMD Boards

Let us start off with the most common processor – the AMD

E350 boards. ASUS E35M1-I and E35M1-I Deluxe have a similar nomenclature, but they are both very different in appearance and the features provided. While the E35M1-I looks well spaced in the sense that there is enough room around the CPU region and RAM slots, although the layout of components is very dense. The E35M1-I Deluxe looks quite congested thanks to the huge passive heatsink along with heatpipes that seems to cover majority of the board area. Both the boards have a passive heatsink. The E35M1-I has six SATA 6 Gbps ports, a single PCIe x16 slot and basic connectivity ports on the back panel including USB 2.0 ports, a LAN port and D-Sub and DVI ports.

The E35M1-I on the otherhand leaves no stone unturned as far as on-board features go. It has a dedicated WiFi adapter slotted in the board, whose wires make their way out to the WiFi antennas. It also has two USB 3.0 ports, an eSATA port and Bluetooth port alongwith five 6 Gbps SATA ports. As far as the feature set is concerned, there was no other board that could match the E35M1-I Deluxe. You will also find a MemOK button on the board which is generally seen on the more mainstream boards which is used to debug the DRAM modules. There is no provision to add a fan on either of the ASUS boards.

The ASUS boards come with UEFI BIOS now commonly